AIA Group (1299.HK): 3Q26 preview: VONB declines yoy on base effect, growth to recover in 4Q

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AIA will report 3Q26 operating metrics on Friday, Oct 30, before market open. We expect VONB to decline -3%/-2% on CER/AER basis, as HK, mainland China and Thailand are likely to show yoy declines. We believe this is an important driver of recent share price weakness, especially if investors attribute the slowdown to weakened demand from mainland Chinese consumers, amid continued news headlines on offshore tax collection (e.g. link).

However, we believe the weakness is mainly a reflection of the high base effect (from sales promotions in 3Q25), while the magnitude of the slowdown was exacerbated by the impact on consumer sentiments. Nonetheless, our estimates imply VONB growth in HK/mainland China are running at 14%/8% 2-year CAGR in 3Q26 (CER basis), despite -6%-8% yoy decline. Therefore, we believe the medium-to-long term growth trend remains intact, driven by affluent consumers' rising savings and protection needs and the low-yield environment in mainland China. **Looking ahead, we expect VONB to recover to double-digit growth in 4Q26, and both HK and mainland China to show double-digit growth in FY27E.**

We fine-tune our estimates to reflect the latest sales and investment market movements. Our 12-month discounted model-based target price is HK$95 (vs. HK$96 previously), implying 1.3X FY27E P/EV (unchanged). AIA is now trading at 1.0X FY27E P/EV, vs. 3-year/5-year historical average of 1.2X/1.4X, and offers total shareholder return yield of 5.4% in FY27E, based on our estimates. We see attractive risk/reward, and believe the recent share price weakness provides good entry points. Reiterate Buy.

Details

We expect 3Q26 VONB of US$1,447mn, -3%/-2% yoy on CER/AER basis, as HK, mainland China, and Thailand are likely to show yoy declines, more than offset growth in the other markets. Sequentially, this represents a further slowdown vs. 13%/8% in 1Q/2Q 2026 on CER basis.

- For 3Q26, we expect -6%/-8%/-4% yoy decline in VONB in HK/mainland China/Thailand. This is mainly a reflection of the high base effects, including 1) strong broker channel promotion in HK, 2) promotion ahead of industry repricing in China, and 3) targeted agency campaigns in 3Q25 in Thailand.

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- Despite yoy decline, our estimates implies 14%/8%/7% 2-year CAGR for HK/mainland China/Thailand, on CER basis. This supports our view that the slowdown is more of a reflection of higher base effect, rather than a structural change in demand.
- Specific to HK, we highlight that the number of mainland Chinese visitors to HK continued to show double-digit growth. We believe this should support a recovery in sales in HK in 2027.

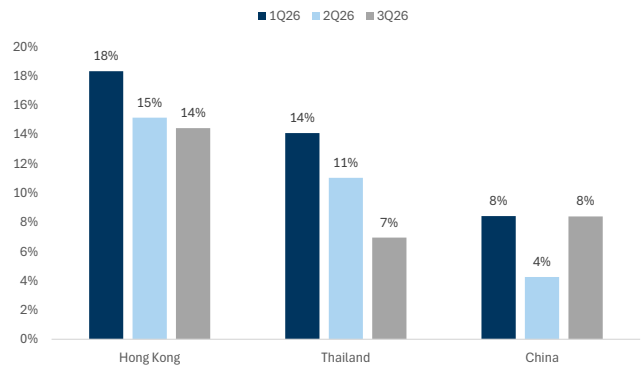
Exhibit 1: We expect HK, mainland China, and Thailand to show yoy decline in 3Q26
AIA VONB growth by market

Value of New Business (VONB) growth	3Q26E			2H26E			FY26E		
	Average exchange rate movement	VONB Growth (CER)	VONB Growth (AER)	Average exchange rate movement	VONB Growth (CER)	VONB Growth (AER)	Average exchange rate movement	VONB Growth (CER)	VONB Growth (AER)
Hong Kong	0%	-6%	-6%	-1%	4%	3%	0%	7%	6%
Thailand	-3%	-4%	-6%	-4%	5%	2%	0%	-1%	0%
Singapore	0%	12%	12%	1%	14%	15%	2%	12%	14%
Malaysia	4%	6%	10%	3%	8%	10%	6%	9%	16%
Mainland China	6%	-8%	-2%	6%	-1%	5%	6%	11%	18%
Others	-2%	5%	3%	-1%	7%	4%	-1%	6%	4%
Group VONB	**1%**	**-3%**	**-2%**	**0%**	**5%**	**5%**	**2%**	**7%**	**9%**

** CER = constant exchange rates; AER = actual exchange rates.*

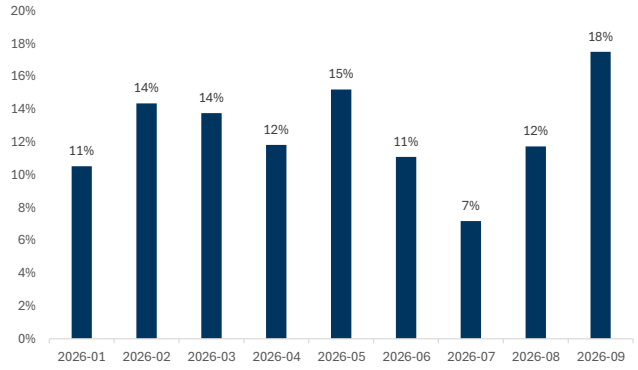
Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Our estimates imply 14%/8%/7% 2-year growth in HK, mainland China, and Thailand in 3Q
2-year VONB growth CAGR (%)



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: We expect growth in mainland China visitors to support HK growth in the medium term
2-year CAGR of monthly visitors from mainland China (%)



Source: WIND, HK Immigration Department

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Exhibit 4: We see -3%/-2% yoy decline in VONB in 3Q26 on CER/AER basis
AIA 3Q26 estimates summary

	Yearly			Half-yearly				Quarterly					vs. 2Q25	
(US$mn unless stated otherwise)	FY25	FY26E	FY27E	1H25	2H25	1H26E	2H26E	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	AER	CER
Value of New Business (VONB)	**5,516**	**6,034**	**6,869**	**2,838**	**2,678**	**3,212**	**2,822**	**1,476**	**1,202**	**1,757**	**1,455**	**1,447**	**-2%**	**-3%**
Hong Kong	*2,256*	*2,398*	*2,789*	*1,063*	*1,193*	*1,168*	*1,230*							
Thailand	*993*	*996*	*1,066*	*522*	*471*	*514*	*482*							
Singapore	*530*	*605*	*669*	*259*	*271*	*294*	*311*							
Malaysia	*373*	*432*	*480*	*192*	*181*	*232*	*200*							
Mainland China	*1,240*	*1,457*	*1,720*	*743*	*497*	*937*	*520*							
Other markets	*485*	*506*	*533*	*249*	*236*	*260*	*246*							
HK reserve and group expense adjustment	*-361*	*-360*	*-388*	*-190*	*-171*	*-193*	*-167*							
New business margin	**58.5%**	**58.4%**	**59.4%**	**57.7%**	**59.3%**	**57.1%**	**59.9%**	**58.3%**	**60.6%**	**56.0%**	**58.5%**	**58.2%**	***-0.1 pp***	***-0.1 pp***
Hong Kong	*68.5%*	*72.0%*	*72.5%*	*65.8%*	*71.0%*	*72.0%*	*71.9%*							
Thailand	*110.9%*	*97.9%*	*97.0%*	*115.5%*	*106.3%*	*96.8%*	*99.0%*							
Singapore	*47.0%*	*46.2%*	*46.7%*	*47.3%*	*46.6%*	*45.7%*	*46.8%*							
Malaysia	*72.2%*	*65.5%*	*68.8%*	*69.1%*	*75.9%*	*61.8%*	*70.5%*							
Mainland China	*57.6%*	*55.5%*	*58.0%*	*58.6%*	*56.2%*	*54.1%*	*58.3%*							
Other markets	*32.0%*	*34.4%*	*33.2%*	*31.6%*	*32.4%*	*34.2%*	*34.7%*							
Annualized New Premium (ANP)	**9,484**	**10,391**	**11,624**	**4,942**	**4,542**	**5,655**	**4,736**	**2,550**	**1,992**	**3,152**	**2,503**	**2,504**	**-2%**	**6%**
Hong Kong	*3,283*	*3,313*	*3,825*	*1,609*	*1,674*	*1,615*	*1,698*							
Thailand	*895*	*1,018*	*1,099*	*452*	*443*	*531*	*487*							
Singapore	*1,128*	*1,309*	*1,433*	*547*	*581*	*644*	*665*							
Malaysia	*515*	*658*	*698*	*278*	*237*	*374*	*284*							
Mainland China	*2,152*	*2,627*	*2,966*	*1,268*	*884*	*1,733*	*894*							
Other markets	*1,511*	*1,467*	*1,603*	*788*	*723*	*758*	*709*							
Total Weighted Premium Income (TWPI)	**46,900**	**52,721**	**57,903**	**23,936**	**22,964**	**27,526**	**25,195**	**11,910**	**11,054**	**14,865**	**12,661**	**13,067**	**10%**	**n/a**

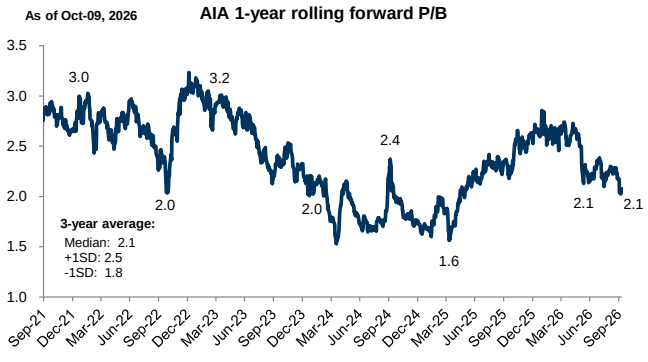
Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: AIA is trading at 1.0X forward P/EV
AIA 1-year forward P/EV (X)



Source: Thomson Reuters, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: AIA is trading at 2.1X forward P/B
AIA 1-year forward P/B (X)



Source: Thomson Reuters, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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Exhibit 7: AIA financial summary

(US$ mn)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
VALUATION					
P/EV (x)	1.4	1.2	1.1	1.0	0.9
NB multiple (x)	6	3	1	NM	NM
P/B (x)	2.4	2.2	2.2	2.0	1.8
P/E (x)	14	15	12	11	10
P/Op EPS (x)	15	13	11	11	9
Dividend yield %	2.5%	2.8%	3.1%	3.4%	3.7%
Total shareholder return yield (%)	6.9%	5.1%	4.7%	5.4%	5.7%
PER SHARE DATA (HK$)					
EVPS	49.9	57.0	64.2	71.4	79.9
NBVPS	3.4	4.1	4.5	5.3	6.0
BVPS	29.3	32.1	31.6	34.7	38.3
EPS	4.82	4.61	5.83	6.38	7.12
Operating EPS	4.66	5.28	6.04	6.59	7.35
DPS	1.75	1.93	2.12	2.34	2.57
Dividend payout ratio %	37.7%	36.6%	35.2%	35.4%	35.0%
PER SHARE DATA (US$)					
EVPS	6.40	7.31	8.23	9.16	10.24
NBVPS	0.44	0.52	0.58	0.67	0.77
BVPS	3.75	4.12	4.05	4.45	4.91
EPS	0.62	0.59	0.75	0.82	0.91
Operating EPS	0.60	0.68	0.77	0.85	0.94
DPS	0.22	0.25	0.27	0.30	0.33
Dividend payout ratio (% of operating EPS)	37.7%	36.6%	35.2%	35.4%	35.0%
GROUP P&L					
TWPI	41,398	46,900	52,721	57,903	63,833
ANP	8,606	9,484	10,391	11,624	13,009
Insurance revenue	19,314	21,618	24,103	26,270	28,689
Insurance service result	5,691	6,772	7,663	7,921	8,503
Investment return	10,882	19,602	19,186	16,338	17,790
Net investment result	3,528	3,342	3,592	4,139	4,595
Operating profits (pre-tax)	7,751	8,552	9,627	10,405	11,415
Non-operating items (net of taxes)	221	(904)	(275)	(278)	(299)
NPAT	6,853	6,267	7,782	8,357	9,175
Operating profits (after-tax)	6,632	7,171	8,056	8,636	9,474
Other comprehensive income (OCI)	(1,032)	1,191	(4,747)	(117)	(132)
Total OCI	5,821	7,458	3,035	8,240	9,043
Attributable to S/H	5,804	7,414	3,049	8,241	9,045
GROUP BALANCE SHEET					
Investment asset	288,621	325,325	352,560	381,329	412,445
Other assets	16,833	20,098	21,326	24,513	27,772
Total asset	305,454	345,423	373,886	405,842	440,217
Insurance & inv. contract liabilities	228,634	264,382	294,586	321,749	350,720
Borrowings	13,329	14,245	14,492	15,092	15,692
Other liabilities	22,678	23,188	22,529	23,369	24,257
Total liabilities	264,641	301,815	331,607	360,210	390,669
Shareholders' equity	40,490	43,245	41,950	45,304	49,222
Net free surplus generation	4,020	4,451	5,061	5,370	5,819
CSM	56,231	64,945	71,149	78,704	87,347
KEY PERFORMANCE MEASURES					
TWPI growth	9.1%	13.3%	12.4%	9.8%	10.2%
ANP growth	12.5%	10.2%	9.6%	11.9%	11.9%
OPAT growth	6.5%	8.1%	12.3%	7.2%	9.7%
NPAT growth	81.2%	-8.6%	24.2%	7.4%	9.8%
VONB growth (actual exchange rate)	**16.8%**	**17.0%**	**9.4%**	**13.8%**	**12.6%**
VONB growth (constant exchange rate)	**17.8%**	**15.1%**	**9.4%**	**13.8%**	**12.6%**
ROA (%)	2.3%	1.9%	2.2%	2.1%	2.2%
Operating ROE (%)	16.2%	17.0%	18.9%	19.8%	20.0%
ROE (%)	16.8%	14.9%	18.2%	19.2%	19.4%
Operating ROEV (%)	14.0%	14.5%	14.9%	14.4%	14.6%
ROEV (%)	11.3%	16.6%	15.3%	14.1%	14.4%
Net investment income yield (%)	2.9%	2.6%	2.5%	2.9%	2.9%
Total investment income yield (%)	6.6%	5.9%	4.7%	4.3%	4.3%
Investment asset growth	7.5%	12.7%	8.4%	8.2%	8.2%

(US$ mn)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EV MODEL					
VONB	4,712	5,516	6,034	6,869	7,733
Expected return	5,628	5,654	6,108	6,738	7,424
Operating experience variances	160	165	488	100	100
Operating assumption changes	28	140	324	41	43
Operating EV profit	10,528	11,475	12,954	13,748	15,300
Investment return variances	(113)	(178)	446	(251)	(272)
Econ. assumption effects	55	308	-	-	-
Other non-op variances	(811)	(364)	41	-	-
Total EV profit	(869)	(234)	487	(251)	(272)
Capital/div. movements	(6,478)	(4,706)	(4,369)	(4,855)	(5,092)
Exchange rate effects	(1,110)	1,803	(184)	-	-
Change in minority interests	20	26	7	-	-
Other adjustments	-	-	-	-	-
Total EV change	(7,568)	(2,877)	(4,546)	(4,855)	(5,092)
Embedded value	69,386	77,279	85,894	94,073	103,533
ANW	30,755	30,970	31,858	32,911	34,209
Required capital	17,154	18,578	18,637	19,135	19,658
Free surplus	12,554	10,972	11,713	12,102	12,694
VIF	38,631	46,309	54,036	61,162	69,324
GEO SEGMENT SUMMARY					
EV as % of total					
Hong Kong	41%	38%	41%	41%	41%
Thailand	14%	13%	13%	13%	14%
Singapore	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%
Malaysia	6%	6%	6%	6%	6%
Mainland China	22%	22%	23%	23%	23%
Other markets	11%	11%	11%	11%	11%
Corporate and others	-4%	-1%	-3%	-4%	-5%
VONB as % of total					
Hong Kong	37%	41%	39%	40%	42%
Thailand	17%	18%	16%	15%	15%
Singapore	10%	10%	10%	10%	10%
Malaysia	7%	7%	7%	7%	7%
Mainland China	26%	22%	24%	25%	25%
Other markets	10%	9%	8%	8%	8%
Corporate and others	-7%	-6%	-5%	-5%	-5%
Op. profit as % of total					
Hong Kong	38%	39%	38%	36%	36%
Thailand	15%	17%	16%	17%	16%
Singapore	10%	10%	10%	11%	11%
Malaysia	5%	6%	6%	6%	6%
Mainland China	24%	24%	24%	25%	26%
Other markets	8%	9%	7%	7%	7%
Corporate and others	0%	-4%	-3%	-2%	-2%
TWPI growth					
Hong Kong	7.8%	18.2%	12.6%	12.1%	12.6%
Thailand	5.6%	14.2%	10.1%	7.7%	7.7%
Singapore	13.6%	18.4%	18.6%	11.6%	11.3%
Malaysia	6.9%	12.0%	14.5%	6.3%	6.4%
Mainland China	15.0%	14.2%	16.4%	11.5%	11.8%
Other markets	4.5%	0.3%	2.1%	3.5%	4.6%
VONB growth (actual exchange rate)					
Hong Kong	23.4%	27.9%	6.3%	16.3%	16.1%
Thailand	14.4%	21.7%	0.3%	7.1%	6.3%
Singapore	15.2%	16.7%	14.1%	10.7%	10.7%
Malaysia	9.4%	6.9%	15.8%	11.0%	6.1%
Mainland China	17.4%	1.9%	17.5%	18.0%	13.0%
Other markets	15.0%	3.9%	4.4%	5.3%	10.3%
New business margin					
Hong Kong	65.5%	68.5%	72.0%	72.5%	73.0%
Thailand	99.4%	110.9%	97.9%	97.0%	95.5%
Singapore	50.6%	47.0%	46.2%	46.7%	47.2%
Malaysia	67.5%	72.4%	65.7%	68.8%	68.8%
Mainland China	56.1%	57.6%	55.5%	58.0%	58.0%
Other markets	29.3%	32.1%	34.5%	33.2%	33.5%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price target risks and methodology - AIA Group

Our 12-month P/EV based target price is HK$95, based on a 1.3X FY27E multiple. Our target multiple is calculated as ROEV - g / COE - g. Our assumed long-term growth rate is 2%. We have a Buy rating on AIA.

Downside risks: Slowdown in mainland China growth, especially for high-margin protection products; delays in regulatory approval for new provinces in mainland China; significant tightening in capital control from mainland China, negatively affecting sales and policy renewal in HK; and broad economic growth weakness in Asia.

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1299.HK	12m Price Target: **HK$95.00**	Price: **HK$71.25**	Upside: **33.3%**

Buy

Market cap: HK$737.6bn / $94.0bn
3m ADTV: HK$2.2bn / $276.0mn
Hong Kong
Greater China Financials
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net inc. ($ mn)	6,234.0	7,760.5	8,357.2	9,175.0
EPS ($) New	**0.59**	**0.75**	**0.82**	**0.91**
EPS ($) Old	0.59	0.79	0.83	0.94
EPS growth (%)	(4.4)	26.5	9.5	11.6
P/E (X)	14.7	12.1	11.1	9.9
Dividend yield (%)	2.9	3.0	3.3	3.6
P/B (X)	2.1	2.2	2.0	1.8
ROE (%)	14.9	18.2	19.2	19.4
P/EV (X)	1.2	1.1	1.0	0.9

	6/26	12/26E	6/27E	12/27E
EPS ($)	0.41	0.34	0.40	0.42

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 9 Oct 2026 close.

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Disclosure Appendix

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Growth is based on a stock's forward-looking sales growth, EBITDA growth and EPS growth (for financial stocks, only EPS and sales growth), with a higher percentile indicating a higher growth company. **Financial Returns** is based on a stock's forward-looking ROE, ROCE and CROCI (for financial stocks, only ROE), with a higher percentile indicating a company with higher financial returns. **Multiple** is based on a stock's forward-looking P/E, P/B, price/dividend (P/D), EV/EBITDA, EV/FCF and EV/Debt Adjusted Cash Flow (DACF) (for financial stocks, only P/E, P/B and P/D), with a higher percentile indicating a stock trading at a higher multiple. The **Integrated** percentile is calculated as the average of the Growth percentile, Financial Returns percentile and (100% - Multiple percentile).

Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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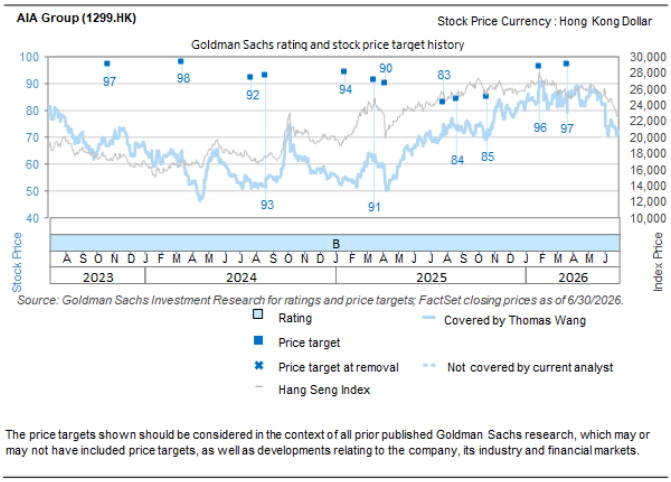
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Target price history table(s)

AIA Group (1299.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK$)	Closing price (HK$)
23-Aug-26	96.00	75.15
22-Mar-26	97.00	86.05
29-Jan-26	96.00	90.95
20-Oct-25	85.00	72.10
23-Aug-25	84.00	72.85
28-Jul-25	83.00	74.05
08-Apr-25	90.00	53.15
17-Mar-25	91.00	62.20
21-Jan-25	94.00	55.50
22-Aug-24	93.00	54.45
25-Jul-24	92.00	50.85
14-Mar-24	98.00	62.25
24-Oct-23	97.00	66.60

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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